

ETIS

Semester Administration & Course Operations Guide

End-to-end semester lifecycle: term creation, sections, roster, teams, review calendar, teaching staff, activation, in-semester changes, archive, and handoff

v0.18.0 release manual edition. Production acceptance has separate source and deployment provenance.

Audience	Course Owners and instructors responsible for course setup/administration
Purpose	Provide a repeatable, first-time-friendly operating procedure for preparing, running, changing, and closing an ETIS semester without losing historical engineering records.
Reference implementation	COMP 330/474 Software Engineering • Fall 2026
Version	v0.18.0 • October 2, 2026

CORE PRINCIPLE

Teaching staff use ETIS to observe engineering reasoning, evidence, and risk without turning activity counts, AI output, or attention signals into grades. Students remain responsible engineers; staff remain responsible educators and course authorities.

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Executive Overview

The semester lifecycle is a controlled administrative sequence. Setup is for preparation, Active is the normal teaching state, and Archived is historical/read-only. ETIS preserves membership, evidence, reviews, findings, and usage history across lifecycle transitions; administration changes current authority and future behavior without rewriting the past.

What this guide enables

- Create a term once and add one or more sections with independent rosters/teams/schedules.
- Import a roster from Sakai gradebook CSV using Student ID and Name while ignoring grade columns.
- Create teams, assign students, and preserve membership history when teams change.
- Configure A1-A6 availability, due/accept-until dates, and release controls by section.
- Assign teaching staff with the minimum role required.
- Activate only after identity, roster, team, repository, and schedule readiness checks.
- Handle adds/drops/team moves without deleting historical engineering records.
- Archive cleanly so student operational access ends while the semester record remains preserved.

Normal teaching-staff path

Create term Add sections Import roster Create teams Set calendar Assign staff Activate Operate Archive

DESIGN BOUNDARY

Normal semester archive is not deletion. Do not treat end-of-semester lifecycle state as permission to delete frozen evidence, review turns, findings/dispositions, membership history, or usage records.

2. Administrative model and source-of-truth boundaries

Durable administrative scope

Course Template	Term	Section	Team	Student
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Boundary	Authoritative source / rule
Official course deadlines and instructions	Sakai remains authoritative.
Semester lifecycle	CourseTerm status: Setup → Active → Archived.
Current course authorization	Active roster, team membership, SectionStaff, term/section state.
Repository trust	Verified team repository through GitHub App exact-repository flow.
Historical evidence/reviews	Frozen snapshots and persisted records; never rewritten to match later course state.

E ETIS ENGINEERING STUDIO SEMESTER ADMINISTRATION & COURSE OPERATIONS	
Boundary	Authoritative source / rule
Schema/runtime	Application release + Alembic + production infrastructure; not managed from Semester Setup.

FORWARD-ONLY LIFECYCLE

Setup prepares. Active teaches. Archived preserves history and ends student operational access. Treat archive as a governance boundary, not a temporary hide/show toggle.

3. Before you create a semester

- Confirm course template/phase contracts are the intended version for the semester.
- Confirm the production service has passed post-deployment acceptance.
- Confirm Course Owner authority and the intended institutional email identity.
- Prepare section identifiers, display names, meeting schedule, roster CSV(s), team plan, A1-A6 dates, and teaching-staff list.
- Know the intended GitHub organization/repository ownership model and who can authorize the ETIS GitHub App.
- Confirm Sakai communication/deadline pages are ready or know which dates remain provisional.

SEPARATE COURSE SETUP FROM INFRASTRUCTURE

Semester Setup configures course/term/section state. It does not provision Azure, change production secrets, or deploy application code. Use the installation/operations documentation for platform changes.

4. Create the course term and sections

Create each semester once, then add one or more sections. Sections inherit the lifecycle template but keep independent rosters, teams, review availability, and date overrides.

SEMESTER SETUP

Course, sections, roster, teams, and review calendar

Start from the COMP 330 lifecycle template, then adjust each section independently as the semester changes.

SECTION: Production Acceptance Test

0 - Course term & sections

Create each semester once, then add one or more sections. Sections inherit the COMP 330 lifecycle template but keep independent rosters, teams, review availability, and date overrides.

New term namespace: COMP330-SP27 Spring 2027

08/23/2026 08/23/2026

Create term

Add section to term: COMP 330 - Fall 2026 (COMP330-F26) 001

Display name (optional): Tue/Thu 8:30-9:45 AM

Add section

1 - Section roster

Import the Sakai gradebook CSV. Only Student ID and Name are used.

Choose File: no file selected

☐ Deactivate students missing from this new roster import

Import roster

2 - Teams

Create teams, then assign or move students. Changes preserve membership history.

team-02 Team name (optional) Create team

Production Acceptance Test Team 1 student(s) - etis-framework/comp330-f26-production-acceptance

Use the Students page to assign or move individual students between teams.

3 - Review calendar & release control

Dates are proposed from the COMP 330 lifecycle template. Each section may override availability, due dates, and release state independently. Sakai remains the course deadline authority.

PHASE	AVAILABLE	DUE	ACCEPT UNTIL	RELEASE	
A1	08/20/2026, 12:05 AM	09/20/2026, 11:55 PM	09/27/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save
A2	09/22/2026, 12:05 AM	09/29/2026, 11:55 PM	10/08/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save
A3	10/01/2026, 12:05 AM	10/15/2026, 11:55 PM	10/22/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save
A4	10/22/2026, 12:05 AM	10/29/2026, 11:55 PM	11/05/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save
A5	11/03/2026, 12:05 AM	11/10/2026, 11:55 PM	11/10/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save
A6	11/05/2026, 12:05 AM	11/24/2026, 11:55 PM	12/01/2026, 11:55 PM	Automatic	Save

Figure 1. Semester Setup top. The page groups term/section creation, roster import, team creation, and the A1-A6 review calendar into one controlled setup workspace. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

1. Open Semester Setup as Course Owner.
2. Create the new term namespace/display label and semester date context.
3. Add each section to the term with the intended section key/display name and meeting context.
4. Select each section explicitly before importing roster or configuring section-specific state.
5. Do not reuse an old Active/Archived term to represent a new semester.

Field / concept	Administrative guidance
Term namespace	Stable semester key; choose a consistent course-term naming convention.
Section key	Stable identifier for the offering within the term.
Display name	Human-readable label for instructor/student navigation.
Meeting context	Helpful orientation; does not replace Sakai calendar/deadline authority.

Field / concept	Administrative guidance
Multiple sections	Share course template but maintain independent roster/team/release state.

5. Import and maintain the section roster

Semester Setup accepts the Sakai gradebook CSV for roster import. ETIS uses Student ID and Name; grade columns are intentionally ignored. Imports should be repeatable and idempotent with respect to the intended current roster.

1. Select the intended section.
2. Choose the current Sakai gradebook CSV.
3. Review whether “Deactivate students missing from this new roster import” matches your intent.
4. Import the roster.
5. Verify student count and spot-check names/IDs.
6. Use Students for individual mid-semester add/reactivate/deactivate actions when that is clearer than a full re-import.

DEACTIVATE MISSING STUDENTS CAREFULLY

Use the deactivation option only when the CSV represents the authoritative complete current roster for that section. Do not deactivate students accidentally because you imported a partial file.

6. Create teams and assign students

Create teams, then assign or move students. Team changes preserve membership history so older reviews/evidence remain interpretable in their original context.

1. Create each team with a stable team key and optional human-readable name.
2. Use Students to assign current students to teams.
3. Verify each team's membership before asking students to onboard repositories.
4. If a student moves later, change current membership; do not delete/recreate historical records.

Situation	Correct action
New team	Create team, then assign students.
Student initially unassigned	Assign through Students.
Student moves teams	Change current assignment; history is preserved.
Team renamed for display	Change human-readable project/team details if supported; preserve stable ID.
Team dissolved	Reassign current students; preserve earlier membership/reviews.

7. Configure review calendar and release control

Each section can override phase availability, due date, accept-until window, and release state. The screenshot shows A1-A6 with Automatic release behavior. Sakai remains the official deadline authority, so course communication and ETIS scheduling must agree intentionally.

Field	Meaning / use
Available	Earliest time the phase becomes available in the Studio.
Due	Course-plan due time for the phase context; keep aligned with Sakai.
Accept until	Late/acceptance window used by the section's release contract.
Release	Controls phase release behavior; Automatic is the current reference example.
Save	Persist the section-specific override for that phase.

DATE CHANGES

If a deadline changes, update Sakai first or in the same controlled change window, then update the ETIS section schedule. Avoid creating two authoritative-looking dates.

8. Add teaching staff and verify authority

Teaching staff are added by institutional email with an explicit role. Authentication and authorization remain separate: adding a staff assignment grants course authority only according to the role and active lifecycle state.

The screenshot displays the 'Semester Setup' interface. At the top, there are two rows for sections A5 and A6. Each row contains three date pickers (Available, Due, Accept until) and a dropdown menu for the Release state (set to 'Automatic'), followed by a 'Save' button. Below this, the interface is divided into two main panels. The left panel, titled '4 - Teaching staff', contains instructions to add instructors, TAs, or reviewers by institutional email. It features a text input field for the email (pre-filled with 'name@luc.edu'), a dropdown menu for the role (set to 'Instructor'), and an 'Add' button. Below this, a list of assigned staff is shown, including 'William O'Connell' with the email 'woconnell@luc.edu' and the role 'course_owner'. The right panel, titled '5 - Term lifecycle', contains instructions on archiving and an 'Archive term' button.

Figure 2. Semester Setup bottom. Teaching-staff assignment and term lifecycle actions are intentionally adjacent because both are elevated administrative responsibilities. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Role	Use it for	Do not use it for
Course Owner	Term lifecycle and elevated administration.	Routine broad assignment when Instructor is sufficient.

Role	Use it for	Do not use it for
Instructor	Assigned-section administration and oversight.	Global authority outside assigned course/section.
TA	Bounded active-semester review/read support.	Roster, lifecycle, repository reset, archived access.
Reviewer	Bounded active-semester review/read role.	Course administration.

1. Add staff using the correct institutional email.
2. Choose the minimum role needed.
3. Have the staff member sign in and verify section context.
4. Confirm administrative controls are absent for TA/Reviewer accounts.

9. Activate the term and perform go-live checks

Activation changes the term from administrative preparation to normal semester operation. Do not activate simply because setup data exists; activate after a deliberate readiness check.

Activation gate

Setup complete	Roster verified	Teams verified	Staff verified	Calendar/release verified	Repository onboarding ready	Activate term
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- Confirm students can authenticate with Loyola identity and the section roster authorizes them.
- Confirm team assignments are correct.
- Confirm staff roles and section selector behavior.
- Confirm the intended repository onboarding instructions are published.
- Confirm A1 availability/release timing is correct.
- Confirm Sakai “Start Here”/course instructions point to the production Studio URL.
- Confirm production acceptance is green and there is no known platform incident.

ACTIVATION EFFECT

Active is the normal state in which student/team/review authorization becomes operational. If activation produces unexpected access, stop and correct roster/staff/lifecycle state rather than adding broad exceptions.

Separate software release from phase release

The v0.18.0 source version is defined in apps/api/app/version.py. FastAPI/OpenAPI and /health use that value. Source version, merged Git SHA, immutable image/revision, deployment success and production acceptance are separate evidence. The August GO records and v0.17 analytical history keep their original dates and versions.

Accepted production uses shadow/shadow evaluation with legacy student-visible authority. Shadow validator/planner/selector/realizer evaluation remains internal and does not replace student-visible authority. This release introduces no PR5 authority transfer, database migration or course-model change.

A software version upgrade does not release A1–A6, change Sakai deadlines or alter active-review evidence. Section phase availability remains instructor-controlled. Verify current student/team access after lifecycle or membership changes while preserving earlier review and evidence context.

10. Operate the semester week to week

Weekly administration loop

Check section context	Scan Command Center	Handle roster/team changes	Monitor repository readiness	Adjust release dates if needed	Coach from evidence/reviews	Watch operational notices
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Area	Weekly question
Roster	Are current students active and correctly assigned?
Teams	Did any membership/project structure change?
Repository	Are teams verified; does any legitimate reset need instructor action?
Release calendar	Are upcoming phase dates still aligned with Sakai?
Reviews/evidence	Are there patterns requiring course clarification or coaching?
AI/cost	Any abnormal operational pattern?
Operations	Any deployment, health, or incident requiring the operations runbook?

11. Adds, drops, reactivations, and team moves

Change	Procedure	Historical effect
Add student	Students → Add / reactivate with institutional Student ID and name → assign team.	No effect on prior records because none exist for the new enrollment.
Reactivate student	Use Add / reactivate for existing identity/enrollment record when appropriate.	Preserves prior context instead of creating a duplicate person.
Drop/deactivate	Deactivate current enrollment.	Ends current course access; prior reviews/evidence/membership remain.
Move team	Change current team assignment.	Earlier team membership/reviews remain historically attributable.
Correct data error	Fix current administrative state using supported UI path.	Do not delete historical review/evidence to make the past look like the correction always existed.

HISTORY IS A FEATURE

Membership events and review history let instructors understand what was true at the time. Do not “clean up” history by deleting records after a legitimate move/drop.

12. Repository onboarding and instructor recovery

Repository onboarding is student/team-driven through nomination, owner/admin authorization, and exact verification. Instructor administration should intervene only when authority or recovery genuinely requires it.

Situation	Instructor action
Organization approval pending	Identify the GitHub organization owner/admin path; wait for approval. Do not reset.
Wrong student GitHub identity	Student relinks their GitHub account. Do not reset verified repository solely for this.
Candidate URL wrong before verification	Student uses the “different repository” path.
Verified repository truly wrong	Instructor/Course Owner resets repository onboarding.
All-repositories GitHub App scope	Do not accept; selected repositories only is required.
Verification fails after approval	Confirm exact repository is selected in App installation, then retry verification.

13. Phase/release changes during the semester

1. Confirm the pedagogical/course decision first.
2. Update Sakai/course communication so students have one authoritative deadline message.
3. Select the intended ETIS section.
4. Change the relevant phase availability/due/accept-until/release control.
5. Save and verify the value.
6. If the phase was already released, consider what students may already have seen/done before making a disruptive change.
7. Document significant exceptions for later course review.

DO NOT USE RELEASE CONTROLS AS PUNISHMENT

Release controls are course administration. They should reflect the course plan or an explicit exception, not be changed reactively based on individual student performance.

14. Archive the term

Archiving is the authoritative end-of-semester operational transition. It ends normal student operational access and makes the term historical/read-only while preserving the engineering record.

Archive lifecycle

Active term	Confirm course completion	Resolve/record known admin issues	Archive term	Student operational access ends	Active reviews → archived_incomplete	Historical read/retention continues
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- Confirm the intended semester is selected before archive.
- Confirm all official course submissions/grades are handled in their authoritative systems.
- Record any reviews that are expected to become archived_incomplete.
- Archive through the supported lifecycle action.
- Verify student operational access ends.
- Verify historical evidence/reviews remain readable to authorized historical staff roles.
- Do not delete the database or infrastructure as part of normal archive.

ARCHIVE IS NOT DELETE

Frozen evidence, review turns, findings/corrections/dispositions, membership events, and AI usage records remain historical records. Retention/deletion is governed separately.

Finding and authorship records to preserve

Only authoritative corrected or resolved findings are closed. Confirmed, evidence disputed, accepted risk and deferred findings remain open. Inspecting, searching, recommending and completing a review do not close a finding; work after the snapshot cannot close it on that earlier snapshot.

Button-triggered instructions are recorded as review actions, not as words the student wrote. Unsent drafts are preserved and remain private. Optional review context and other concerns stay secondary to the current concern and conversation.

Retain original snapshot provenance, explicit findings/dispositions and persisted action metadata when archiving. Do not treat machine-triggered turns as student-written responses in later teaching or research interpretation.

15. Post-archive records, retention, and handoff

- Confirm the archive date and semester identifier in administrative records.
- Preserve required evidence/review history according to institutional/course policy.
- Do not assume TA/Reviewer active-semester authority continues into archive.
- Use the Backup/Recovery/DR runbook for platform-level retention/recovery checks.
- If the application will be decommissioned rather than merely the semester archived, follow the Installation & Administration decommission procedure.

16. Semester administration troubleshooting

Problem	Likely boundary	Response
Student authenticates but cannot enter	Roster/term/section authorization	Verify Active term and active enrollment.
Student in wrong team	Current membership	Move current assignment; preserve history.
Roster import would deactivate unexpected students	Import file/options	Stop. Confirm complete CSV and deactivation checkbox intent.

Problem	Likely boundary	Response
TA cannot add student	Role boundary	Expected. Use Instructor/Course Owner.
Instructor cannot archive	Course Owner authority	Archive is elevated lifecycle authority.
Old section appears in selector	Historical/authorized context	Confirm term status; do not mutate archived state.
Phase not available when expected	Release/calendar	Check selected section and availability/release configuration against Sakai.
Verified repo must change	Repository trust	Use bounded reset, not database edit.
Archived term writable	Lifecycle enforcement	Treat as production blocker and escalate.
Student access persists after archive	Authorization/session revocation	Treat as production blocker and escalate to operations/security.

17. Appendix A - Semester start checklist

- Term created once with correct semester identity.
- All sections added and selected correctly.
- Roster imported and verified.
- Teams created and students assigned.
- Teaching staff assigned with least privilege.
- A1-A6 calendar/release controls reviewed against Sakai.
- Students receive repository onboarding instructions.
- Course Owner/Instructor can use Command Center, Teams, Students, Reviews, Engineering Evidence, Semester Setup.
- TA/Reviewer accounts lack elevated administration.
- Production acceptance green; canonical URL works.
- Term activated only after readiness review.

18. Appendix B - Mid-semester change playbooks

Playbook: late add

1. Add/reactivate student through Students.
2. Assign intended team.
3. Confirm student signs in and inherits current section/team state.
4. Explain repository/team history already in progress.
5. Do not fabricate backdated membership.

Playbook: student drops

1. Deactivate current enrollment.

2. Confirm current operational access ends.
3. Preserve prior review/membership/evidence history.
4. Adjust current team membership/work planning as needed.

Playbook: team move

1. Move current student to new team.
2. Confirm future authorization follows new membership.
3. Do not rewrite old team reviews/evidence.
4. Tell instructors reviewing history to interpret older sessions in original team context.

Playbook: schedule extension

1. Make the course decision.
2. Update Sakai authoritative deadline communication.
3. Update the intended ETIS section/phase dates.
4. Verify save and student-visible availability.
5. Document material exception if appropriate.

19. Appendix C - End-of-semester checklist

- Confirm final course deadlines/submissions are complete in Sakai/Review Center as applicable.
- Review unresolved administrative issues and repository bindings.
- Record any active Studio reviews that will archive incomplete.
- Archive the correct term.
- Verify student operational access ends.
- Verify historical records remain.
- Confirm authorized staff historical access posture.
- Hand off backup/recovery/retention checks to the operations/DR procedures.
- Do not delete infrastructure unless the application itself is being intentionally decommissioned.

20. Appendix D - Administrative invariants

- CourseTerm.status is authoritative for Setup / Active / Archived.
- Archived terms cannot grant current student/team/review mutation authority.
- Authentication does not equal course authorization.
- Staff authority is term/section scoped and role bounded.
- Roster/team changes preserve historical membership and review context.
- A verified repository is changed only through bounded reset + normal re-verification.
- A pasted repository URL is never trusted evidence.
- Frozen FACT evidence is immutable.
- Unsent student drafts remain private.
- Sakai remains authoritative for official course deadlines/instructions.
- Archive preserves records; retention/deletion is a separate governance decision.